WP-4B-06: Time-critical medicines and missed doses

Example General Hospital, Ward 4B. Version 3 (fictional). Owner: Ward 4B nurse in charge (fictional role).

FICTIONAL TRAINING DOCUMENT. Not clinical guidance. Example General Hospital is fictional.

Scope

All medicines given on Ward 4B.

Time-critical medicines on Ward 4B

- Insulin.
- Medicines for Parkinson's disease.
- The first dose of an antimicrobial.
- Anticoagulants, including enoxaparin.
- Antiepileptic medicines.

Administration windows

Give time-critical medicines within 30 minutes of the scheduled time. Give all other medicines within 60 minutes of the scheduled time.

When a dose is missed or delayed

- Record the dose as not given in MedTrack with a reason code: refused, nil by mouth, unavailable, patient absent from the ward, or held for a clinical reason.
- For a time-critical medicine, inform the nurse in charge immediately.
- Never double a dose to make up for a missed one unless the prescriber advises it.

Unavailable medicines

If a medicine is not in stock, contact the pharmacy within 30 minutes for a time-critical medicine and within 2 hours for any other medicine.